
Direct Payments support area

Direct Payments are monetary payments from the council that are made to individuals who request them, in order to meet some or all of their eligible social care and support needs. People who take a Direct Payment choose and pay for their care and support services themselves. Direct Payments offer an alternative to Managed Personal Budgets, which involve the council arranging and paying for the care and support services that are needed. Direct Payments allow for flexible approaches to be used to meet a person's outcomes.

Benefits of using a Direct Payment

- More choice and control for the person who requires support
- Allow more flexibility than a Managed package – under the Care Act DPs can be used more creatively as long as it meets the outcomes / assessed needs and creative uses of the DP is encouraged.
- Can be used to employ own Personal Assistant or purchase appropriate equipment
- Can be more creative how an individual's support needs are met
- Can be used to promote an individual's independence
- Allows support to be more person focused and often more sustainable than traditional managed services.
- Can be a more cost-effective option

Support

Here you will find information and tools to support you to explain and promote the use of direct payments to people, carers and colleagues from other organisations.

As part of an ongoing strategic commissioning project to improve the use of direct payments, a newly established Employment Support Officer is available to provide initial advice about Employment responsibilities, guidance on posting a job vacancy and support with sourcing a Personal Assistant.

Policy and staff guidance

- [Direct payments policy](#)
- [Staff guidance document](#)
- [Direct Payments calendar 2026-2027 \[PDF\]](#)
- [DPSS Presentation for Team Manager March 2022 \[PPT\]](#)
- [Condensed Direct Payment process 2023 \[Word\]](#)
- [Direct Payment with an Agency checklist](#)
- [Commissioning a DP step by step guide \[Word\]](#)
- [Commissioning a top-up step by step guide \[Word\]](#)
- [Request for Services Agency step by step guide \[Word\]](#)
- [Completing a DP Agreement step by step guide \[Word\]](#)
- [Direct Payment Agency Commissioning Maps \[PDF\]](#)
- [Direct Payment - what you need to know for 2026 \[PPT\]](#)

Direct payment support services

- [Step by step DPSS Changes to Care and Support Plans and Commissioning \[Word\]](#)
- [Transferring DPSS Providers \[Word\]](#)

Personal Assistant commissioning

- [Direct Payments Personal Assistant Commissioning Team Presentation \[PPT\]](#)
- [User Guide - Direct Payment Personal Assistant Commissioning Process \[Word\]](#)
- [Direct Payments Personal Assistant Commissioning Process Webinar \[YouTube\]](#)
- [Direct Payment Personal Assistant Commissioning Map 2026 \[PDF\]](#)

Direct Payments Calculator

- [DP Calculator in Mosaic \[PPT\]](#)
- [DP Calculator in Mosaic step by step guide \[Word\]](#)
- [DP Calculator guidance for multiple changes including uplifts \[Word\]](#)

Forms and letters

- [DBS \(Disclosure Barring Service\) Form \[Word\]](#)
- [Guide-Employer Information \[Word\]](#)
- [DPSS Order Form \[Word\]](#)
- [PA DBS non engagement letter \[Word\]](#)

- [Confirmation of PA status \[Word\]](#)
- [Direct Payment Top-up Agreement \[Word\]](#)
- [Direct Payment Agreement form ACM39 August 2025 \[Word\] electronically editable](#)
- [Data Release form - for DPSS transfers \[Word\]](#)
- [DPSS data transfer consent form \[Word\]](#)
- [Direct Payment Know Your Customer Agreement \[Word\]](#)

Factsheets and frequently asked questions

- [Explanation of a Direct Payment - factsheet 1](#)
- [Employing a Personal Assistant - factsheet 2](#)
- [Pre-paid Debit Cards - factsheet 3](#)
- [How to find and recruit a PA - factsheet 4](#)
- [Selecting a Direct Payments Support Service - factsheet 5](#)
- [Direct Payment Auditing - factsheet 6](#)
- [Direct Payment contributions - factsheet 7](#)
- [Is your PA Employed or Self-employed - factsheet 8](#)
- [Personal Assistants at Home Network factsheet](#)
- [Living in a care home - direct payments factsheet](#)
- [FAQ's from the DP PA briefings](#)
- [Direct Payment voluntary top up factsheet](#)
- [Pre-Paid cards- Know Your Customer Fact sheet \[PDF\]](#)

Publications and toolkits for employing a personal assistant

- [Employing a Personal Assistant toolkit - Skills for Care](#)
- [Understanding the employment status of PAs \[PDF\]](#)
- [ACAS guidance for new employers \[PDF\]](#)
- [Individual employer privacy notice template \[Word\]](#).
- [Skills for Care - Information for Social Workers about supporting people to become individual employers \[PDF\]](#)

Flowcharts

- [Chart A Direct Payments Auditing – ACFS role and responsibilities \[PDF\]](#)

- [Chart B - actions and outcomes \[PDF\]](#)
- [Chart C - ACFS escalation process for non-compliance \[PDF\]](#)
- [Chart D - staff guidance on non-return of Direct Payments bank statements \[PDF\]](#)
- [DBS Process Map \[PDF\]](#)
- [Care and Support Plan Mosaic Changes \[ODT\]](#)
- [DP Misuse Decision Tree \[PDF\]](#)
- [DBS \(Disclosure Barring Service\) Process \[Excel\]](#).
- [New Process for sourcing PAs for Hospital Discharge and Missed calls \[PDF\]](#)
- [Direct Payment and Homecare Pathway \[PDF\]](#)

Request for the return of direct payment money following an audit or when a Direct Payment is ceased

Direct payment recipients or their friends or family members can now return unused direct payment money using an easy but [secure online payment form](#).

They will need to have the debit card for their direct payment bank account to hand.

They need to:

- complete the relevant boxes
- confirm how much they are returning
- quote the reference that they will have been given in a letter sent from the Direct Payment team.

This is a quick and hassle-free way to return funds on our request. It also saves time and resources this end associated with the banking of cheques, identifying payments received by income, and matching payments to people.

Please encourage direct payment users and their friends or family members to use this online facility for returning direct payment monies to the Council.
